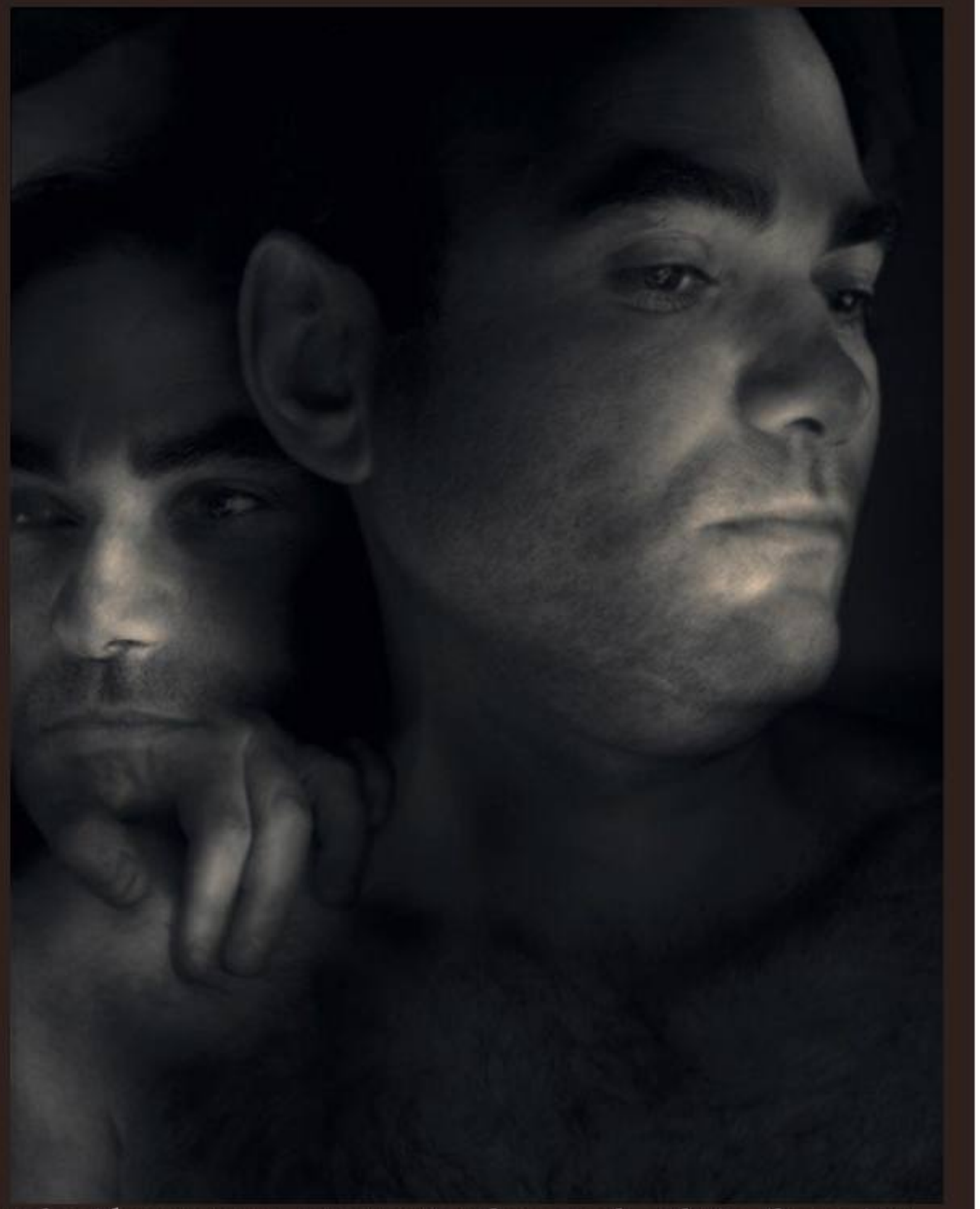
All Around Our Spaces

For the prompt ‘What is Space?’ I wanted to explore personal space, details around people, how they interact with themselves and others within their own personal space, and how far can personal space reach, be it an entire room, or direct skin contact. What personal space means for each person is different, and the feelings it can cause are different, albeit comfort, stress, and anger.

Through self-portraiture and more candid portraits I want to show our relationships with personal space, the feelings it brings, the comfortability it brings, as well as the uncomfortably.



Schneider, G. (1989). *John Double* [Photograph, gelatin silver print]. Retrieved from https://www.garyschneider.net/image-portfolios/john/

Gary Schneider is a photographer who was born and studied in South Africa, and moved to New York to work. His photography is specialized in portraits, and self-portraiture.

I enjoy the stark contrast of Gary Schneider's work, he focuses carefully using lighting on the typically overlooked features of the human face. He uses additions of different lenses, and double exposure to extend his composition from just being typical head on shot of people or zoomed in shots of facial details, I enjoy the message and detail shown in his photographs, and photographic series that connect together to tell a story.

I plan on incorporating Gary Schneider's focus on smaller details, and stark contrast into my own work. I enjoy his use of double exposure, however through my own testing I can get a similar effect with a longer shutter speed and good timing.



Schneider, G. (1996). John in Sixteen Parts [Photograph, gelatin silver print]. Retrieved from https://www.garyschneider.net/image-portfolios/john/

F-Stop



16



8.0



4.5

Shutter Speed



1/200



1/30



1"

ISO



1600



3200



6400

Testing Positioning, colour, and Composition

















Final Colour choice

I decided I wanted my photos to have a warm element to them. A use the subject matter itself to either lean into that idea, or to subvert it





Final



Less in frame



Model looking into camera



Something in background





The final choice of photo felt the most natural, the framing fit both faces perfectly, and the exposure from the light source gave the best level of contrast.



Final



Too far from the camera



Not enough contrast



Too cold feeling





The final photo felt the most warm, the models sit perfectly in the frame taking up the center, and the lighting over both faces highlights expression the best.



Final



Doesn't fill up the frame



Second face is too blurry

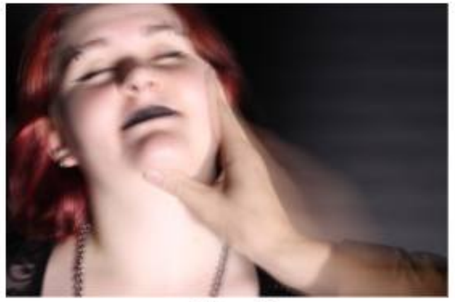


Composition feels less interesting





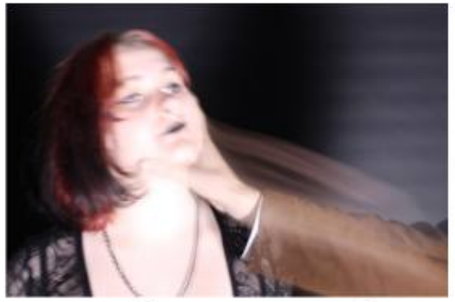
The final picture takes up the most of the frame whilst giving the perfect level of contrast. The other images felt warped and unnatural for the position, but the final choice looks the most natural, the shutter speed leaves both stills in focus.



Final



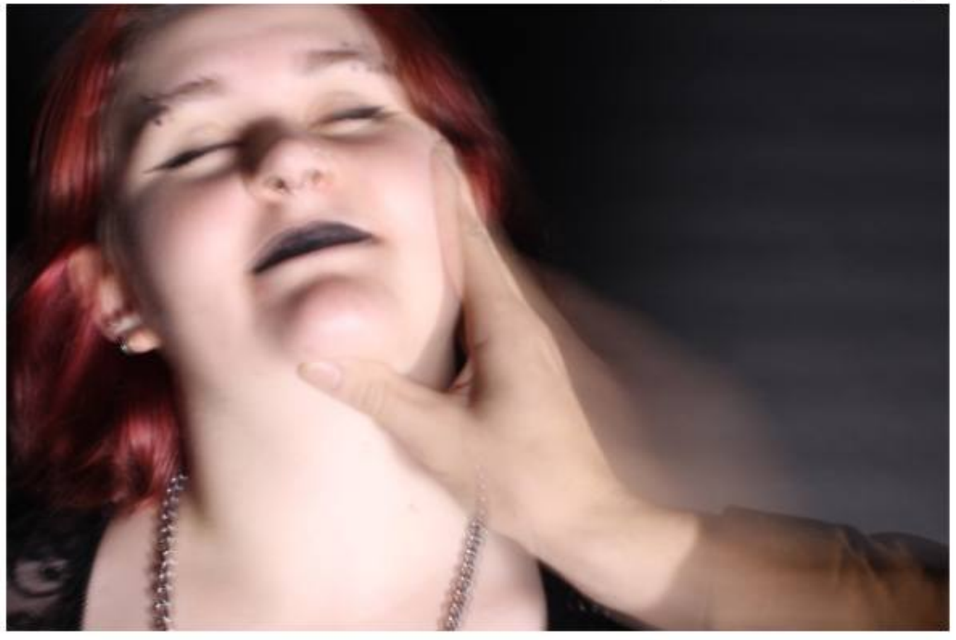
Shutter Speed was too long



Looks too unatural



Too far, Shutter speed was too long





The final image comes out the least bright, with good contrast between the shadows and light. The model looks natural and content with the pose, and the composition leads the eye to their face.



Final



Too Staged



Not in focus, glass isn't visable



Too clustered





The final image balances the out of focus hand with the face the best, not taking up the whole frame, but showing enough detail to see the hand squished against the glass and that the definitive shape is a hand.



Final



Too Soft



Too clustered, not enough contrast



Nothing drawing the eye





The final photo felt the most balanced in space used, the focus of the camera, and the way the angling leads the eye. The contrast is balanced, and you are able to make out the minor details in the darker side of the face.



Final

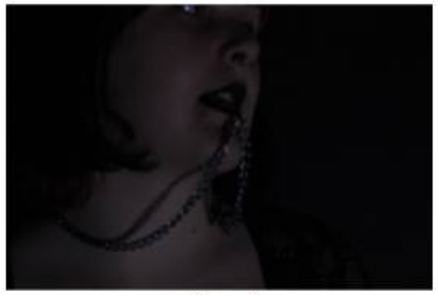


Under Exposed

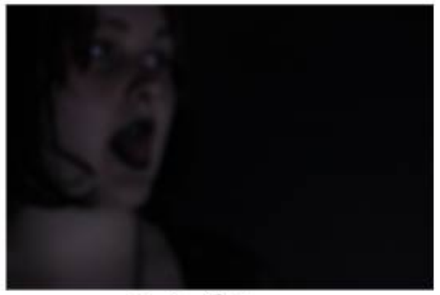




These shots were taken as testing, to see the range in which the model could move within the frame, and how comfortable with how they could present themself infront of the camera. The candidness of the photo struck me, as the model got comfortable with their personal space.



Final



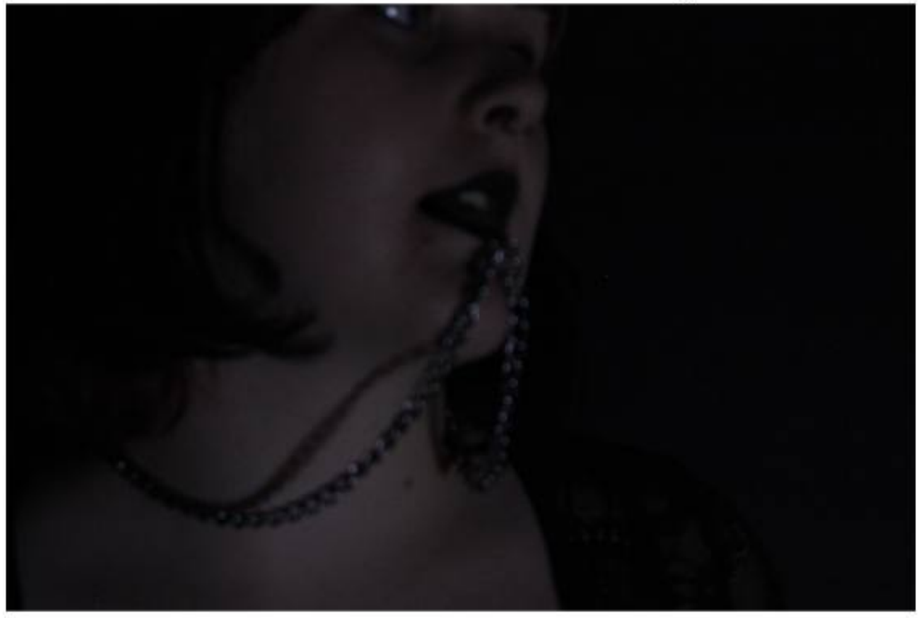
Out of Focus



Too blurry



Wrong lighting angle





These Shots were done as test shots for a potential idea based on my previous test shots, and to test lighting in the studio space. I choose the photo where the model is biting down on the necklace for it's angling, I like the way the focus of the photograph is not the models centeral face and features, instead only the jaw and mouth.



Final



Under-Exposed



Mouth out of frame



Too high and unatural





From the photos above, my choosen final I decided on was the best framed, I thought the slight movement down, and the corner of the teeth within the frame felt the most natural, and showed the best possible angle of the model's face.



Final



Open eyes felt unnatural



Too close, too low a angle



Glass isn't detailed enough





The choosen final photo felt the most leaned into, the model looked the most content, and the framing sat between the closeness of other shots and the distance of the other. The way the models face is squished into the glass in the final creates the most interesting shape.







half hope…i have loved none but you.

Austen. J. Persuasion.



if i loved you less, i might be able to talk about it more

Austen. J. Emma.









know your own happiness.

Austen. J. Sense and Sensibility..



till this moment I never knew myself.

Austen. J. Pride and Prejudice.









beware how you give your heart.

Austen. J. Northhanger Abbey..











